Nielsen Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

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PRODUCT: MedCare
TASK: Inbox Evaluation

1 Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues	Recommendations
Order updates are shown but the status or process could be clearer.	Use clear status labels like "Processing" or "Out for delivery"

2 Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues	Recommendations
The terms like "System notification" and "Order message" are way too technical. Some of the messages are too formal and not user-friendly.	Replace the technical terms with just simple terms, "Updates" instead of "System Notification". Use conversational messages like "Your medicine is ready".

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

No visible "Cancel Order" or "Change Order" option.

No back button or undo actions.

Recommendations

Add a "Cancel" or "Modify Order".

Provide a clear back button and undo options for actions.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

Message interface differs slightly from the notification layout.

Recommendations

Keep similar layouts for similar features like the notification layout.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues	Recommendations
Risk of ordering wrong medicine or quantity.	Include a validation like quantity limits.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues	Recommendations
Limited visible details in chat/or order summary.	Display the full order details before confimation.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and funtionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

No shortcuts for frequent users like reorder previous medicine.

Recommendations

Add "Reorder" button for past purchases.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnescessary elements been removed?

Issues

Some texts are too crowded, repetitive messages formats which reduce the clarity of the message.

Recommendations

Reduce texts highlight information. Use spacing and icons to improve readability.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues	Recommendations
No error guidance or feedback when something is wrong.	Add a clear error message like "Medicine is out of stock"

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues	Recommendations
No visible help section. First-time user may be confused.	Add a FAQ or help section. Provide a tooltipsfor users